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EduOS Cameroon — Baseline Data Annex

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Purpose	Single verified evidence base cited by the Investment Case, Budget/TCO, Economic Analysis, and M&E Framework

Every figure carries its source and year. Figures that could not be independently verified are flagged **ESTIMATE** with the recommended primary source for confirmation during appraisal. Figures marked (*WB API*) were retrieved directly from the World Bank open-data API.

1. Country context

Metric	Value	Year	Source
Population	29.88 million	2025	World Bank SP.POP.TOTL (<i>WB API</i>)
GDP (current US\$)	US\$58.93 billion	2025	World Bank NY.GDP.MKTP.CD (<i>WB API</i>)
GDP growth	3.5%	2024	World Bank Macro Poverty Outlook, Cameroon
Exchange rate	1 USD ≈ 574 XAF; XAF pegged to EUR at 655.957	Jul 2026	market rate; BEAC peg
Administrative structure	10 regions · 58 divisions · 360 sub-divisions	current	Government of Cameroon administrative gazette

2. Education system scale

Metric	Value	Year	Source
Primary schools — public	>14,000	2021/22	MINEDUB Annuaire Statistique 2021/22
Primary schools — private	~8,000	2021/22	MINEDUB Annuaire Statistique 2021/22
Primary schools — total	>22,000	2021/22	MINEDUB Annuaire Statistique 2021/22
Secondary schools — total	4,131 establishments (2,760 public / 1,371 private): 2,734 general, 831 technical, 387 polyvalent, 179 teacher-training; 3,820 functional. Working figure for current year: ~4,100–4,500 (growth since 2017/18; ~3,408 general secondary structures reported Sept 2020)	2017/18	MINESEC Annuaire Statistique 2017-2018, Tableaux 306–308 (INS PDF, parsed directly); newer annuaires (to 2024/25) exist on minesec.gov.cm as PDFs
Primary enrolment	5,289,656	2024	World Bank/UIS SE.PRM.ENRL (WB API)
Secondary enrolment	2,007,361	2023	World Bank/UIS SE.SEC.ENRL (WB API)
Total learners in scope	≈ 7.3 million	2023/24	sum of above
Primary gross enrolment ratio	114.4%	2024	World Bank/UIS SE.PRM.ENRR
Primary school-age population	~4.6 million (derived : enrolment ÷ GER)	2024	derivation
Private share of primary	25.3%	2024	World Bank/UIS SE.PRM.PRIV.ZS

Metric	Value	Year	Source
enrolment			
Private share of secondary enrolment	30.6%	2023	World Bank/UIS SE.SEC.PRIV.ZS
Primary teachers	121,453	2024	World Bank/UIS SE.PRM.TCHR (WB API)
Secondary teachers	118,092	2023	World Bank/UIS SE.SEC.TCHR (WB API)
Pupil-teacher ratio (primary)	44.8	2018 (latest UIS)	World Bank/UIS SE.PRM.ENRL.TC.ZS

3. Textbook sector baseline

Metric	Value	Year	Source
Pupil-textbook ratio, pre-reform	12 pupils per book nationally; up to 30:1 in disadvantaged areas — among the lowest availability in Sub-Saharan Africa	2016	World Bank results brief “Turning Pages, Transforming Lives” (Feb 2024)
Pupil-textbook ratio, post-reform	3 essential textbooks (French, English, Mathematics) per 2 students in public primary; >4 million children reached	2023	World Bank results brief; GPE country journey
Textbook price reform	Prices previously ~3× comparable countries; reduced >50% since 2014; availability in public schools quadrupled	2014–2023	World Bank results brief
National policy target	Textbooks for every student by 2026	2024	World Bank results brief
Textbook policy	Free essential textbooks in public primary schools; single approved textbook per subject	2017–	Government policy, per World Bank/GPE
Textbook unit cost (average, procurement)	US\$6.25 (2013) → US\$2.90 (2020) ≈ 1,750 FCFA post-reform	2020	World Bank results brief (verified FR edition)
Textbook retail prices (homologated, printed on book)	Primary 1,200–2,000 FCFA/book; secondary ~1,900–5,000 FCFA/book; full primary essential package 14,750–16,500 FCFA for 10–11 books (2025/26)	2023–2026	Official MINEDUB/MINESEC homologated lists (press transcriptions)
Programme distribution volume	11+ million textbooks distributed free to ~13,000 public primary schools under PAREC; programme financing ≈ 57 bn FCFA (IDA + GPE)	2018–2024	PAREC programme site; Investir au Cameroun
SSA supply-chain benchmark	Distribution is a recurrent failure and cost point in SSA textbook chains (“Where Have All the Textbooks Gone?”, World Bank 2015)	2015	Read, World Bank 2015

Metric	Value	Year	Source
Cameroon-measured leakage (PETS III)	~30% of the monetary value of school “minimum package” supplies lost between council dispatch and school receipt; >80% of school heads waited 3–6 months for resources; 11.8% of heads reported losses during withdrawal; >20% of delegates admitted irregular spending; 1 in 5 inspectorates received only 20–40% of expected programme resources	2019	INS PETS III Education report (85 pp., English), Executive Summary pp. 8–10 — extracted directly

4. Education financing

Metric	Value	Year	Source
Education expenditure, % GDP	2.84%	2023	World Bank SE.XPD.TOTL.GD.ZS (WB API)
Education expenditure, % of government spend	13.83%	2024	World Bank SE.XPD.TOTL.GB.ZS (WB API)
MINESEC budget	583.1 bn FCFA (2025) → 595.2 bn FCFA (2026)	2025/26	national budget documents (press)
MINEDUB budget	334.3 bn FCFA	2026	national budget documents (press)
PAREC (Education Reform Support Project) allocation	32.27 bn FCFA in 2025	2025	Cameroon Tribune
ERSP/PAREC (P160926) total	IDA US\$175M (incl. US\$45M additional financing) + GPE grant US\$52.45M; components include free textbook provision in both subsystems	2018–	World Bank project P160926 PAD
Recent PAREC top-up	16 bn FCFA additional World Bank injection	2024	The Guardian Post
Sector strategy anchor	Education and Training Sector Strategy 2023–2030	2023	Government of Cameroon

5. Connectivity and power (design-driving constraints)

Metric	Value	Year	Source
Internet penetration	41.9% (12.4M users)	Jan 2025	DataReportal Digital 2025: Cameroon
Mobile connections	25.4M = 87.5% of population; 83.6% of connections on 3G/4G/5G	2024	DataReportal
Coverage pattern	4G in major and secondary cities; 3G in most towns; rural gaps with 2G-only or no-signal villages	2024/25	operator coverage maps (nPerf)
Electricity access — national	72%	2023	World Bank EG.ELC.ACCS.ZS (<i>WB API</i>)
Electricity access — rural	26%	2023	World Bank EG.ELC.ACCS.RU.ZS (<i>WB API</i>)

Design implications (normative for architecture): with rural electricity at 26% and meaningful no-signal zones, any school-level system **MUST** operate offline-first (see FRS NFR-NTR-05: 90-day disconnected operation) and the equipment budget **MUST** include solar charging for off-grid schools. These are not optional hardening measures; they are baseline conditions.

6. Data-gap status (updated July 2026)

Gap	Status
Secondary school count	CLOSED — 4,131 (2017/18, parsed from MINESEC Annuaire); refresh to 2024/25 annuaire at appraisal (PDFs exist on minesec.gov.cm but are not machine-readable)
Textbook unit costs	CLOSED — US\$2.90 $\approx$ 1,750 FCFA average post-reform; homologated retail ranges verified
PETS III leakage	CLOSED — ~30% minimum-package value leakage + 3–6 month delays, extracted from the report itself
School-level GPS dataset	CLOSED AS A FINDING: none exists. No official open machine-readable school dataset with GPS for Cameroon. MINESEC’s internal “carte scolaire numérique” is geo-referenced but unpublished; HDX offers only a crowdsourced OSM education-facilities export (incomplete); Giga/UNICEF coverage of Cameroon unconfirmed. Implication: the NSR seed (FRS-NSR §9) must combine ministry internal extracts + OSM proxy + the funded division-level GPS verification campaign — and the registry itself becomes the country’s first authoritative open school dataset, a distinct programme benefit.

Remaining appraisal-stage refresh: pull the 2024/25 MINESEC annuaire tables and the exact ERSP textbook-component spend from ISRs.